METRIC

A-A-20276
March 17, 1999

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHICKEN NUGGETS, FINGERS, STRIPS, FRITTERS, AND PATTIES, FULLY COOKED, INDIVIDUALLY FROZEN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers individually frozen, fully cooked, solid muscle, chunked and formed or ground/chopped and formed, breaded or unbreaded, seasoned or unseasoned, chicken nuggets, fingers, strips, fritters, and patties (chicken products) packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The frozen, fully cooked chicken products shall conform to the classifications in the following list and shall comply with USDA, Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS), Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations, (9 CFR Part 381) and applicable State regulations. When applicable, the frozen, fully cooked chicken products shall comply with the USDA, Food and Nutrition Service (FNS), Child Nutrition Programs, National School Lunch Program (7 CFR Part 210, Appendices A and C), which shall be specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Program (FQAP), Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), USDA, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243, telephone (202) 720-9939, or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8905

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Types, styles, batter/breading, meat types, skin types, vegetable protein products (VPP), fat ranges, shapes, unbreaded product, flavored or topical seasoning/coating, meat/meat alternates, grain/bread equivalents, and Child Nutrition (CN) labeling.

Type I - Nugget
Type II - Finger
Type III - Strip
Type IV - Fritter
Type V - Patty
Type VI - Other

Style A - Whole muscle
Style B - Chunked and formed, ½ inch cube or greater (9 CFR § 381.171(f))
Style C - Ground/chopped and formed, ½ inch cube or smaller (9 CFR § 381.171(f))

Batter/breading 1 - Unbreaded, fully cooked, individually frozen (IF)
Batter/breading 2 - Breaded, fully cooked, IF

Meat type a - Natural proportion (50-65 percent white, 50-35 percent dark) (9 CFR § 381.117)
Meat type b - 100 percent white meat
Meat type c - Mostly white meat (not less than 66 percent white, not more that 34 percent dark)
Meat type d - 100 percent dark meat
Meat type e - Mostly dark meat (not less than 66 percent dark, not more than 34 percent white)
Meat type f - Other

Skin type (1) - With skin (natural proportions) (9 CFR § 381.117)
Skin type (2) - Without skin

VPP (a) - with vegetable protein products (VPP), soy protein concentrate 1/
VPP (b) - with vegetable protein products (VPP), soy protein isolate 1/
VPP (c) - with vegetable protein products (VPP), textured vegetable protein 1/
VPP (d) - with combinations of protein products (VPP) 1/
Egg (e) - with dried whole eggs 1/

1/ Not available in Style A

Fat range i) - Not more than 5.0 grams of fat per serving
Fat range ii) - 5.1 to 10.0 grams of fat per serving
Fat range iii) - 10.1 to 15.1 grams of fat per serving
Fat range iv) - 15.1 to 20.0 grams of fat per serving
Fat range v) - Other

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Shape a) - Irregular
Shape b) - Strip
Shape c) - Other

Unbreaded product (I) - Flamed, broiled, or flamed broiled (specify)
Unbreaded product (II) - Grilled with/without (char) markings (specify)
Unbreaded product (III) - Other

Flavored or topical seasoning/coating for unbreaded product (A) - Barbecue
Flavored or topical seasoning/coating for unbreaded product (B) - Mesquite
Flavored or topical seasoning/coating for unbreaded product (C) - Other
Flavored breaded product (D) - Italian style
Flavored breaded product (E) - Other

When Meal Pattern Contribution information is required:

Meat/meat alternate (M/MA) - Purchaser shall specify the M/MA serving requirement according to USDA, FNS-255, Value of USDA - Donated Foods for Schools and Institutions, School Meal Patterns for various Age/Grade Groups. **Example:** 1 serving of chicken nuggets must equal 2 ounces of M/MA, regardless of number per serving.

Grain/bread equivalent (G/B) (1)) - One serving provides ½ serving of G/B 2/
Grain/bread equivalent (G/B) (2)) - One serving provides ¾ serving of G/B 2/
Grain/bread equivalent (G/B) (3)) - One serving provides 1 serving of G/B 2/

2/ Grain/bread equivalent (G/B) requires enriched flour.

CN labeling (a)) - With a CN label
CN labeling (b)) - Without a CN label

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Basic requirements:

3.1.1 Fully Cooked: The product shall be cooked by any method or combination of methods allowed by the Poultry Products Inspection Regulations. A minimum internal product temperature of 71.1°C (160°F) shall be obtained during cooking (9 CFR § 381.150 and Appendix A -- Compliance Guidelines for Meeting Lethality Performance Standards for Certain Meat and Poultry Products).

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3.2 **Ingredients**:

3.2.1 **Chicken**: The chicken meat shall be derived from fresh chilled and/or previously frozen (9 CFR §§ 381.65 and 381.66) broilers/fryers.

3.2.1.1 **Unacceptable chicken meat**: No mechanically separated (comminuted) or previously cooked chicken meat may be used in these products.

3.2.1.2 **Chicken skin**: The skin may be attached to the meat for Style A (if required). Chicken skin may be used in Style B and C chicken products. Chicken skin used in Style B and C must be emulsified and thoroughly mixed with the meat and other ingredients.

3.2.1.3 **Raw chicken defects**: The chicken meat shall be free of bone or bone fragments, cartilage, coarse connective tissue, tendons or ligaments, and discoloration.

3.2.2 **Monosodium glutamate (MSG)**: No MSG maybe added to the meat or to any other ingredient.

3.2.3 **Vegetable protein products (VPP)**: The VPP used shall be identified by its common and usual name in the ingredient statement. The VPP shall be in accordance with the requirements of the UDSA, FNS Regulations (7 CFR Part 210, APPENDIX A).

3.2.4 **Oils**: No coconut, palm kernel, or other tropical oils shall be allowed in the cooking process. The deep fat fryer oil shall be continuously filtered.

3.2.5 **Batter/breading**: Commercially prepared batter/breading ingredients commonly used for the type of product specified shall be permitted.

3.2.6 **Batter/breading combinations**: Combined batter and breading for chicken nuggets, fingers, strips, and patties shall not exceed 30 percent by weight. The chicken fritters can contain up to 65 percent batter and breading and must contain at least 35 percent meat. The chicken nuggets, fingers, strips, fritters, and patties shall be uniformly coated with batter and breading.

3.3 **Reprocessing (rework)**:

3.3.1 **Product eligible for reprocessing**: Uncooked, unbattered, unbreaded, or unbatter/breaded chicken products are eligible for reprocessing.

3.3.2 **Product ineligible for reprocessing**: Battered, breaded, batter/breaded, cooked, or cooked batter/breaded chicken products are ineligible for reprocessing.

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3.4 **Chilling/Freezing:** The cooked chicken products shall be chilled in accordance with FSIS Regulations Directive 7110.3, Rev. 1, TIME/TEMPERATURE GUIDELINES FOR COOLING HEATED PRODUCTS and Appendix B -- Compliance Guidelines for Cooling Heat-Treated Meat and Poultry Products (Stabilization). The cooked chilled chicken products shall be individually frozen in a manner that will prevent the chicken products from sticking together after freezing. Immediately after individual freezing, the product shall be packaged and placed in a freezer held at -17.8°C (0°F) or below. The internal product temperature shall be lowered to -17.8°C (0°F) or lower within 72 hours from the time the product enters the freezer. The internal product temperature shall not exceed: (a) -17.8°C (0°F) at the time of shipment, and (b) -12.2°C (10°F) at time of delivery.

3.5 **Metal detection:** All product must be examined by a metal detection device capable of detecting metals that may be present in the product.

3.6 ***Finished product:*** The cooked chicken products shall comply with the following requirements:

3.6.1 **Appearance and color:** The cooked chicken products shall have a uniform color characteristic of cooked chicken; and the meat shall have no discoloration. The cooked breaded product shall have a golden brown color that is no lighter than the "light tolerance" or darker than the "dark tolerance" shown within the tolerances of the current edition of the USDA, AMS, Poultry Programs color control guidelines.

3.6.2 **Odor and flavor:** There shall be no foreign odors or flavors such as, but not limited to burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

3.6.3 **Texture:** The chicken products shall be moist and tender. The chicken product shall not be fractured (separated into two or more separate pieces), scorched or burned, soggy, excessively oily, greasy, or sticky.

3.6.4 **Defects:** The chicken products shall be free of bone or bone fragments, cartilage, coarse connective tissue, tendons or ligaments, and discolored meat.

3.6.5 **Cooked breaded products:** The cooked, breaded chicken products shall have not more than one area of larger than 0.64 cm (0.25 inch). The cooked, breaded chicken products shall contain no lumps (outcropping of breading on the surface of the nugget, finger, strip, fritter, and patty) or ridges (excess breading which projects at the surface of a nugget, finger, strip, fritter, and patty).

3.7 **Foreign material:** The chicken products shall be wholesome and not adulterated, which covers all forms of foreign materials and contamination.

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3.8 **Storage time**: Unless otherwise specified, the maximum storage time for frozen cooked chicken products, at -17.8°C (0°F) or below, is 120 calendar days.

3.9 **Protein and salt content**: The protein and salt content for the chicken products shall not exceed the amount specified on the "Nutritional Facts" panel.

3.10 **Analytical requirements**: When specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, analytical testing shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International or an AOAC International equivalent method.

3.10.1 **Microbiological analysis**: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the microbiological analysis for chicken products shall not exceed the following values:

Standard Plate count	- Less than 25,000 colony forming units (CFU) per gram
Salmonella	- Negative

Microbiological:	**Test**	**Method**
	Standard Plate Count	966.23, 990.12
	Salmonella	986.35

3.10.2 **Sample preparation for chemical analysis**: The sample shall be prepared according to the AOAC test method 983.18.

Chemical:	**Test**	**Method**
	Fat	922.06
		960.39, 985.15, or 991.63 (unbreaded meat samples only)
	Protein	988.05
	Salt	935.47

3.10.3 **Test results**: The standard plate count shall be reported to the nearest 100th of a percent. Salmonella results should be reported as positive or negative. The fat, protein, and salt shall be reported to the nearest 10th of a percent. Any result not conforming to the analytical testing shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3.11 **Nutritional information**: The purchaser may require proof of nutritional information.

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4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

The chicken products shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The delivered cooked chicken products shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, processing, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the chicken products within the commercial marketplace. Delivered chicken products shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. *Purchaser shall specify 5.1 or 5.2.*

5.1 Product conformance. The chicken products shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same chicken products offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 USDA certification. When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that chicken product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Grading Branch, Poultry Programs, AMS, USDA, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable Poultry Programs' procedures. The chicken products shall be examined or tested for compliance to the product requirements in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Commercial packaging and packing shall be in accordance with current practices that are commercially acceptable for consumer-type packaging and packing. The marking and labeling of the product shall be in accordance with the requirements of 9 CFR Part 381. The labels shall be approved by the Facilities, Equipment, Labeling and Compound Review Division, FSIS, USDA, prior to use (9 CFR § 381.132). If required, preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking are different from normal commercial required practices, purchaser shall specify the requirements in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Product type(s).
- Style(s).

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- With or without batter/breading.
- Meat type(s).
- Skin type(s) - with or without skin.
- Fat range(s).
- Product conformance (5.1) or USDA certification (5.2).
- Packaging, if different from normal commercial requirements practice.

7.2 Purchasers may specify:

- VPP and/or dried whole eggs.
- Shape(s).
- When flamed, broiled, or flamed broiled.
- When grill with/without (char) marking placement is other than contractor's option.
- Seasoning(s) for unbreaded or breaded products.
- Meat/meat alternate(s).
- Grain/bread equivalent(s).
- CN labeling.
- Analytical testing.
- Nutritional information.

7.3 USDA certification contact.

For USDA certification, contact the Grading Branch, Poultry Programs, USDA, STOP 0258, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0258, telephone (202) 720-4411, or FAX (202) 690-3165.

7.4 Sources of documents.

7.4.1 Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

7.4.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations are contained in 9 CFR Parts 301 to end and 7 CFR Parts 53 to 209. The Food and Nutrition Service Regulations are contained in 7 CFR Part 210. Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the

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Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1803 **or on the Internet at: http://www.nara.gov/fedreg.**

Copies of the Color Control Guidelines for Chicken Products are available from: **USDA, Poultry Programs, STOP 0258, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0258.**

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, USDA, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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